PIONEER · EDITION 004

The Weight of Words

Vision 2040 | Winning Hearts through Honour and Excellence

August 2026 · Featuring Rev. Tokunbo Adejuwon

The era of honour. You cannot possess a land you do not honour — true pioneering is not an invasion, it is an invitation. The National Director brings the conversation full circle, and Daniel shows how a captive won an empire through honour, intellect and excellence.

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FROM THE VISIONNAIRE'S DESK

A Conversation with the National Director, Part IV

For the past few editions we have heard from the National Director about the heart behind Vision 2040, the call to pioneer, and what it takes to establish Rhema in new territories. This edition brings the conversation full circle.

Rev. Tokunbo Adejuwon — National Director, Rhema Bible Training Centre Nigeria

> This edition, we bring the conversation to a close. But perhaps "close" isn't quite the right word — because when it comes to pioneering, one conversation ending should always lead to another question.

What is the greatest sacrifice you believe this vision will require from us as an organisation?

Ah, there will be a lot of sacrifices. I believe the first thing is that we have to change our thinking — change our mindset. We cannot afford to be selfish.

One of the greatest things will be getting to the point where we are not trying to project ourselves, where we don't care who gets the credit, and we keep our eyes on what truly matters:

- the lost who need to be saved
- believers who need to grow and mature
- and Jesus, who has a plan that we want to be a part of

So the sacrifice is this: it's not about me. It's about God's plan. It's about the lives of people. It's about the eternal destinies of men.

It will require a shift in our mindset and our attitudes. It will also require proper alignment — square pegs in square holes, round pegs in round holes. We have to get to the point where we are not focused on my position, your position, or their position, but rather: what is the best fit so that we can get this done?

It's going to take our faith. Faith is what will get this done. It will take our prayers. It will take being led by the Spirit of God. It will take making this a priority. So again, selflessness — putting God's plan first, putting people next, and putting ourselves last. That is a major shift.

Also, when you think expansion, you must understand that it will require us to relinquish control. If you are operating like a sole proprietor, you control everything — but you don't grow big. But when you move into a multinational mindset, you lose some control, you empower more people, and you build systems.

THE SHIFT

From "I do everything" to "we have systems that multiply results." And that shift is not always easy. There will be discomfort. It may ruffle feathers. Change is never comfortable. Nobody naturally embraces change — we all prefer what is familiar.

But we are stepping into new territory — into the unknown. However, these are calculated steps:

- with God on our side
- with the leading of the Spirit
- with faith in our hearts
- and with love working among us as a team

There will be a need for greater spirituality, because we are entering waters we have not charted before. At times, we may rub against each other. We may step on each other's toes. But we must extend grace to one another and stay focused on the goal. At the end of the day, the price will never be greater than the grace of God.

And the results — the fruit of it — will make every sacrifice worth it. Because of the joy set before us, we can endure anything. There is a joy ahead of us. The fruit will be astonishing. And the truth is this: nobody ever goes down lifting others up.

To the person reading this who feels a stirring but thinks they are "unqualified", what is your final word?

I'll tell you something. Peter felt unqualified. When he met Jesus, after the catch of fish, he said, "Depart from me, for I am a sinner." Yet he became the one who spearheaded the move of God's Spirit in the early church.

Saul of Tarsus persecuted the church. He was a blasphemer — injurious to the cause of Christ. Yet he ended up writing a significant portion of the New Testament and became perhaps one of the most outstanding Christian workers in the history of the Church.

So yes, they felt unqualified. If you feel unqualified, it's okay. That is why we have training. And besides, nobody ever did something great for God in their own strength. If you could do it in your strength, then you wouldn't need God — but we need God.

Brother Hagin once said, "If I could just have 50 students and train them every year…" — that was all he was thinking at the time. When the Lord was leading him, it was almost like, "Can't you send somebody else? Just give me a small church somewhere at the back side of nowhere."

So truly, welcome to the club of people that felt unqualified.

- People like Elisha, who was tending oxen.
- People like Joshua, who was serving Moses.
- People like Philip, who was serving food.

It's okay to feel unqualified. That is why we have:

- God's Word
- God's Spirit
- the community of believers
- and structured training to equip people

So it's fine. Come on over. It's people like you we are looking for. Because someone who feels unqualified will depend more on God's grace. It's like Gideon — when the angel said, "Mighty man of valour," he looked around as if to say, "Who are you talking to?" Yet God used him to bring a mighty deliverance.

Thank you very much, sir. Any final words?

This will work. This will succeed. We are well able to take the land. We are well able to overcome the giants — the giants of unbelief, doubt, fear, and the voices that say, "It can't happen, it won't happen."

We are well able. This is our day. This is our time. We are in our finest hour. The best days of Rhema were not 10, 20, or 30 years ago. The best days of Rhema are the days ahead of us. God knew we were able — that is why He planted us in this generation, in this season, and in this time. He is counting on us.

And the truth is: it shall be done. We will see campuses across Nigeria — 40 campuses is not even much. It's small compared to what God is able to do. Across West Africa — 15 countries, one Rhema

campus in each. When you look at it, some of those countries combined are not even as large as Lagos. So it is more possible than we think.

We have strength in our numbers. We are well able. God has strategically positioned Nigeria for such a time as this. There is resilience in Nigerians. There is adaptability. Nigerians think big. Nigerians are driven — and all of Africa knows it.

And beyond that, the solution to many of our challenges — even in security, economy, and society — is here. If we can get people born again, Spirit-filled, trained, and established — if we can build strong churches — many of these issues will be addressed.

THE FINAL WORD

So this vision is not only of eternal value; it has real impact even in the present. This is the way forward. This is a God-given vision, in a God-ordained season, for a God-prepared people — to produce God-sized results.

> *Nobody ever goes down lifting others up.*

> *The best days of Rhema were not 10, 20, or 30 years ago. The best days of Rhema are the days ahead of us.*

COUNTRY FOCUS

The Republic of Sierra Leone

To win a nation, you must first know its story.

POPULATION SIZE

~7.9 Million (2026 est.)

A nation of incredible resilience. Having overcome civil war and health crises, the people have a grit that makes them powerful disciples once they grasp the Word of Faith.

DOMINANT RELIGIONS

Islam 78% & Christianity 21%

Sierra Leone is a global model for religious harmony. Christians and Muslims frequently celebrate together. The strategy is transformation, not comparison.

CHRISTIAN EXPRESSION

Protestant / Pentecostal (Growing)

There is a high value on community peace. The Rhema message of peace through the Word resonates deeply here.

LITERACY RATE

~48% (Rising)

A rising but uneven literacy base. Teaching must be structured to work spoken as well as read — systematic, repeatable, and easy to carry into a community by voice.

PRIMARY LANGUAGES

English & Krio

English is the official language, but Krio is the language of the heart. Krio is the gist — a pioneer who masters small-small Krio demonstrates a level of honour that breaks down every wall.

YOUTH POPULATION

~60%

A generation looking for a new identity. They don't want to be defined by their past; they want to be defined by their potential.

URBAN VS RURAL

Concentrated around Freetown

The capital holds the density, while rural regions remain underserved. Expansion outside the major cities remains one of the greatest opportunities.

BIBLE SCHOOLS

Developing

Most schools are denominational. A Rhema campus in Freetown would be the first to offer a structure of faith that is non-denominational and globally standardised.

DID YOU KNOW?

Lion Mountain

The name "Sierra Leone" means Lion Mountain. The people are lions — bold and courageous. When you win a Sierra Leonean to the Word of Faith, you haven't just won a member; you've won a Protector of the Truth.

THE 10/40 GAP

Sierra Leone sits on the western edge of the 10/40 window. With a 78% Muslim majority and a young, peaceable population, it is a frontier where the Word advances through relationship and honour rather than confrontation.

STATE FOCUS

Ebonyi State

Salt of the Nation.

GEOPOLITICAL ZONE

South-East

A state defined by its agrarian backbone, where practical, value-adding ministry earns the right to be heard.

POPULATION SIZE

~3.9 Million

A vibrant population spread across 13 Local Government Areas. While Abakaliki is the economic and political centre, Ebonyi's real strength is anchored in agrarian hubs like Izzi, Ikwo, Ezza, and Afikpo.

DOMINANT RELIGION

Christianity (Predominant)

A deeply Christian population. The focus isn't basic evangelism, but moving believers from religious routine into active, faith-filled community.

CHRISTIAN EXPRESSION

Catholic, Anglican, Methodist & Fast-Growing Pentecostal

A deeply rooted Christian heritage. The primary need is moving believers and local pastors from denominational survival to kingdom impact through practical, Word-based ministry training.

LITERACY RATE

~65–70%

Formal literacy in English is moderate-to-high among the youth, but localised Igbo dialects hold intense emotional weight. Teaching that blends simple English with local expressions takes root fastest.

PRIMARY LANGUAGES

Igbo (Izzi, Ezza, Ikwo, Afikpo dialects) & English

Igbo is the everyday language of connection. A pioneer who understands and honours local dialectic identities turns from a visitor into a long-term partner.

YOUTH POPULATION

~60–65%

An energetic youth group seeking empowerment, leadership development, entrepreneurship, and world-class skills to break cycles of poverty and rural drift.

URBAN VS RURAL

High Rural Concentration (~75–80%)

Beyond Abakaliki and key town centres, the majority live in agricultural communities. Impact strategies must prioritise mobile outreach, satellite training hubs, and community-level engagement.

BIBLE SCHOOLS

Abundant Churches / Scarce Schools

While churches are widespread, systematic ministry training remains scarce. The need is structured discipleship and visionary leadership training that equips local ministers to transform their communities.

PIONEER PRO-TIP

The “Salt of the Nation” Approach

Just as salt preserves, seasons, and gives flavour, the mission in Ebonyi must be to preserve vision and release value. In a state known for its grit and agricultural strength, we lead with empowerment, character, and practical skill. We aren’t just bringing lectures; we are building self-sustaining leaders who bring practical transformation to their communities.

THE BIBLICAL OG OF PIONEERING

Daniel

The Pioneer of the Palace — the man who won an empire through honour, intellect, and excellence.

> *Then the king talked with them, and among them all none was found like Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah… And in all matters of wisdom and understanding about which the king examined them, he found them ten times better.*
>
> DANIEL 1:19–20

If you think pioneering is only about loud street preaching, meet Daniel. Dropped right into the centre of Babylon — the ultimate high-tech, intellectual superpower of his day — he didn’t panic, protest, or compromise.

Instead, he pulled off the ultimate flex: he out-thought, out-worked, and out-classed everyone in the room.

01. Story Time — The Palace Revolution

Selected as a young captive to serve in Nebuchadnezzar's elite administrative pipeline, Daniel was plunged into the heart of a hyper-intellectual, highly pagan empire. The Babylonians changed his name, shifted his geography, and tried to rewrite his identity.

Instead of waging ideological war, Daniel instituted a culture of honour.

THE RESPECTFUL REFRAME

When offered the King's lavish (and non-kosher) diet, Daniel didn't throw a fit. He pitched a low-risk, 10-day "veggie trial" to his manager. Result? Better skin, higher energy, zero drama.

THE BULLETPROOF RECORD

Daniel wasn't just a prophet; he was an Executive Director. He managed government finances so efficiently that when his political rivals searched his tax records for dirt, they found absolutely nothing suspicious (Daniel 6:4).

MYTH VS FACT

Myth: Daniel succeeded purely as a mystic who interpreted dreams. Fact: He was an elite executive administrator. His political influence came from an excellent spirit and bulletproof execution. Myth: Pioneering requires attacking local culture. Fact: Daniel honoured the structure without worshipping its gods. Honour opens doors that confrontation locks.

02. The Pioneer Lesson — The "10X" Mandate

Whether you're stepping onto an academic campus in Ekiti, an industrial centre in Ebonyi, or a diplomatic district in Freetown, don't lead with noise — lead with quality.

When your teaching is sharper, your team is tighter, and your integrity is unshakeable, even your harshest critics will ultimately promote you.

PIONEER PRO-TIP

The Open Window Strategy

Daniel ran a literal global empire, but he still blocked out time three times a day for his altar (Daniel 6:10). Your public influence will never outgrow your private quiet time. Keep that window open!

> *Honour opens doors that confrontation locks.*

YOUR NEXT STEP

Find Your Place in the Vision

Vision 2040 is not a project for a few people — it is a mission for all of us.

> Whether God is calling you to pioneer, support those on the field, or help prepare the way for future campuses, there is a place for you in this vision. Here are three practical ways to get involved today.

01 · JOIN THE VISION

Expression of Interest

If you wish to volunteer, serve on an expansion team, support our ongoing initiatives, or explore contribution opportunities for Vision 2040, we welcome your outreach. Complete the Expression of Interest form and tell us where you would like to serve.

02 · SHARE A CONTACT OR RECOMMEND A LOCATION

Contact & City Recommendation

Do you know of a city, town, community, church, or ministry that could host a future Rhema campus? Your recommendation could play a vital role in our expansion efforts. Submit a campus recommendation and help us map the frontier.

03 · PREPARE TO PIONEER

Pioneer Development Programme

Not everyone is called to pioneer a Rhema campus. Some are called to plant churches, launch ministries, begin outreaches, or take the Gospel into places where Christ is not yet known. If you sense that God is calling you to pioneer something, we'd love to walk that journey with you through training, mentorship, and practical equipping. Register for the Pioneer Development Programme.

Every great work begins with a single step — take yours today.